

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PM 4
ROADSIDE STAND

Marks :
Duration :

Name :
Exam No. :

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Extract 1

*"The little old house was out with a little new shed
In front at the edge of the road where the traffic sped,
A roadside stand that too pathetically pled,
It would not be fair to say for a dole of bread,
But for some of the money, the cash, whose flow supports
The flower of cities from sinking and withering faint."*

Questions

1. **Multiple Choice Question (MCQ)** What is the primary purpose of the roadside stand, as described in the extract?
 - (a) To beg for food
 - (b) To sell goods and earn money
 - (c) To attract tourists
 - (d) To provide shelter for travelers
 - **Answer:** (b) To sell goods and earn money
2. **Assertion/Reasoning Assertion (A):** The roadside stand is described as "pathetically pled." **Reason (R):** The stand represents the struggles of rural people to earn a livelihood.
 - (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
 - (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
 - (c) A is true, but R is false.
 - (d) A is false, but R is true.
 - **Answer:** (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
3. **Literary Device** Identify the literary device used in the phrase "pathetically pled."
 - (a) Alliteration
 - (b) Personification
 - (c) Metaphor
 - (d) Hyperbole
 - **Answer:** (a) Alliteration
4. **Fill in the Blank** The roadside stand is located at the _____ of the road where traffic moves quickly.

Answer: edge

5. **Complete the Statement** The phrase "cash, whose flow supports the flower of cities" suggests that _____. **Answer:** urban prosperity depends on the exploitation of rural areas.
6. **Find a Word** Find a word from the extract that means "to beg or appeal earnestly." **Answer:** Pled
7. **Mood/Tone** What is the tone of the extract?
- (a) Optimistic
 - (b) Sympathetic
 - (c) Sarcastic
 - (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Sympathetic

Extract 2

*"No, in country money, the country scale of gain,
The requisite lift of spirit has never been found,
Or so the voice of the country seems to complain,
I can't help owning the great relief it would be
To put these people at one stroke out of their pain."*

Questions

1. **Multiple Choice Question (MCQ)** What does the speaker suggest about rural life in the extract?
- (a) It is full of joy and prosperity.
 - (b) It lacks financial and emotional upliftment.
 - (c) It is self-sufficient and content.
 - (d) It is disconnected from urban life. **Answer:** (b) It lacks financial and emotional upliftment.
2. **Assertion/Reasoning Assertion (A):** The speaker feels a sense of helplessness about the plight of rural people. **Reason (R):** The speaker wishes to end their suffering but acknowledges the complexity of their struggles.
- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
 - (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
 - (c) A is true, but R is false.
 - (d) A is false, but R is true. **Answer:** (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
3. **Literary Device** Identify the literary device used in the phrase "the requisite lift of spirit."
- (a) Metaphor
 - (b) Personification
 - (c) Hyperbole
 - (d) Alliteration **Answer:** (a) Metaphor
4. **Fill in the Blank** The speaker acknowledges that rural people often complain about their _____. **Answer:** hardships

5. **Complete the Statement** The phrase "put these people at one stroke out of their pain" reflects the speaker's _____. **Answer:** frustration and desire to alleviate rural suffering.
6. **Find a Word** Find a word from the extract that means "necessary or essential." **Answer:** Requisite
7. **Mood/Tone** What is the tone of the extract?
- (a) Hopeful
 - (b) Resigned
 - (c) Compassionate
 - (d) Critical **Answer:** (b) Resigned

Extract 3

*"Sometimes I feel myself I can hardly bear The thought of so much childish longing in vain,
The sadness that lurks near the open window there, That waits all day in almost open prayer
For the squeal of brakes, the sound of a stopping car."*

Questions

1. **Multiple Choice Question (MCQ)** What does the "childish longing" in the extract symbolize?
- (a) The innocence of rural children
 - (b) The desperate hope of rural people for customers
 - (c) The carefree nature of rural life
 - (d) The speaker's nostalgia for childhood **Answer:** (b) The desperate hope of rural people for customers
2. **Assertion/Reasoning Assertion (A):** The rural people wait in vain for customers to stop at their roadside stand. **Reason (R):** The sound of a stopping car represents hope for financial gain.
- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
 - (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
 - (c) A is true, but R is false.
 - (d) A is false, but R is true. **Answer:** (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
3. **Literary Device** Identify the literary device used in the phrase "sadness that lurks near the open window."
- (a) Personification
 - (b) Simile
 - (c) Metaphor
 - (d) Alliteration **Answer:** (a) Personification
4. **Fill in the Blank** The rural people wait all day in prayer for the sound of a _____. **Answer:** stopping car
5. **Complete the Statement** The phrase "squeal of brakes" symbolizes _____. **Answer:** hope and anticipation for financial relief.

6. **Find a Word** Find a word from the extract that means "hidden or concealed." **Answer:** Lurks
7. **Mood/Tone** What is the tone of the extract?
- (a) Hopeful
 - (b) Desperate
 - (c) Joyful
 - (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Desperate

Section B: Short Answer Questions (10 × 2 = 20 marks)

☐ **Story-Based Questions (2 × 2 marks)**

1. **How does the roadside stand reflect the struggles of rural people?** **Answer:** The roadside stand symbolizes the rural people's desperate attempts to earn a livelihood. It reflects their longing for urban prosperity, which often remains unfulfilled due to urban indifference. Their efforts to attract customers highlight their struggles and the economic disparity between rural and urban areas. **Marking Scheme:**
- 1 mark: Mention of rural struggles and livelihood.
 - 1 mark: Explanation of urban indifference and economic disparity.
2. **What does the speaker mean by "childish longing in vain"?** **Answer:** The phrase refers to the innocent yet futile hope of rural people for customers to stop and buy their goods. Despite their earnest efforts, their hopes are often unmet, symbolizing the emotional despair and helplessness of rural communities in their quest for recognition and support. **Marking Scheme:**
- 1 mark: Explanation of "childish longing" as innocent hope.
 - 1 mark: Description of unmet hopes and emotional despair.

☐ **Value-Based Questions (2 × 2 marks)**

3. **What values are highlighted in the speaker's sympathy for rural people?** **Answer:** The speaker reflects values of compassion, empathy, and social justice. He sympathizes with the rural people's plight and critiques the exploitation they face. The poem urges readers to recognize the contributions of rural communities and address the inequalities they endure. **Marking Scheme:**
- 1 mark: Mention of compassion and empathy.
 - 1 mark: Explanation of social justice and critique of exploitation.
4. **How does the poem critique urban attitudes toward rural life?** **Answer:** The poem critiques urban indifference and exploitation, showing how rural people are ignored despite their contributions to urban prosperity. Urban dwellers speed past the roadside stand, indifferent to the struggles of rural communities, highlighting the disparity between urban and rural lives. **Marking Scheme:**
- 1 mark: Mention of urban indifference.
 - 1 mark: Explanation of exploitation and disparity.

☐ **Competency-Based Questions (2 × 2 marks)**

5. **How does the metaphor "the requisite lift of spirit" enhance the meaning of the poem?** **Answer:** The metaphor highlights the lack of emotional and financial

upliftment in rural life. It emphasizes the struggles and unfulfilled aspirations of rural people, who yearn for recognition and support from urban society but often face neglect and indifference. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Explanation of emotional and financial upliftment.
- 1 mark: Description of rural struggles and aspirations.

6. **What does the "squeal of brakes" symbolize in the poem?** **Answer:** The "squeal of brakes" symbolizes the rural people's hope for financial relief and their anticipation of customers stopping at their stand. It represents their longing for recognition and support, which is often unmet, leaving them in despair. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Explanation of hope for financial relief.
- 1 mark: Description of unmet expectations and despair.

□ **Literary Device-Based Questions (2 × 2 marks)**

7. **Identify and explain the literary device in "sadness that lurks near the open window."** **Answer:** The literary device is personification, as sadness is given human qualities of lurking near the window. This emphasizes the emotional despair of rural people, who wait in vain for customers to stop at their roadside stand. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Identification of personification.
- 1 mark: Explanation of emotional despair.

8. **What literary device is used in "pathetically pled," and what does it convey?** **Answer:** The literary device is alliteration, as the repetition of the "p" sound creates emphasis. It conveys the desperation and earnest appeal of rural people for financial support, highlighting their struggles and helplessness. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Identification of alliteration.
- 1 mark: Explanation of desperation and appeal.

□ **Character-Based Questions (2 × 2 marks)**

9. **How does the speaker portray the rural people in the poem?** **Answer:** The speaker portrays rural people as hardworking yet helpless, struggling to make a living and yearning for recognition and support. Their innocence and desperation are highlighted through their futile attempts to attract customers at the roadside stand. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Mention of hardworking and helpless nature.
- 1 mark: Description of innocence and desperation.

10. **How does the speaker's tone reflect his attitude toward rural life?** **Answer:** The speaker's tone is sympathetic and critical, reflecting his deep concern for the plight of rural people. He critiques urban indifference and exploitation while expressing empathy for the struggles and unfulfilled hopes of rural communities. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark: Mention of sympathetic tone.
- 1 mark: Explanation of critique and empathy.

Section C: Long Answer Questions (Content is given with sub titles for students' understanding only. It's not compulsory to use them.)

1. Theme-Based Question

Q. Discuss the central theme of “A Roadside Stand.” How does the poem highlight the struggles of rural people and critique urban attitudes?

Answer: Introduction The poem *A Roadside Stand* by Robert Frost explores the struggles of rural people and their longing for urban prosperity. It critiques the indifference of urban dwellers toward the plight of the countryside.

Content

- **Rural Struggles:** The roadside stand symbolizes the desperation of rural people to earn a livelihood. They hope for customers to stop and buy their goods, but their efforts often go unnoticed.
- **Urban Indifference:** Frost highlights how urban people exploit rural areas for their own prosperity while ignoring their hardships. The phrase "pathetically pled" reflects the helplessness of rural people.
- **Contrast Between Rural and Urban Life:** The poem contrasts the simplicity and innocence of rural life with the materialism and selfishness of urban attitudes.

Conclusion Through vivid imagery and poignant language, Frost emphasizes the need for empathy and justice for rural communities. The poem serves as a critique of societal inequalities and urban exploitation.

2. Value-Based Question

Q. What values are reflected in the speaker's sympathy for rural people in “A Roadside Stand”? How does the poem promote social justice?

Answer: Introduction The poem reflects values of compassion, empathy, and social justice through the speaker's concern for rural people and their struggles.

Content

- **Empathy and Compassion:** The speaker sympathizes with the rural people's plight, acknowledging their desperation and unfulfilled hopes. The phrase "childish longing in vain" highlights their innocence and helplessness.
- **Critique of Urban Exploitation:** Frost critiques the urban exploitation of rural areas, showing how urban prosperity depends on the labor and resources of the countryside.
- **Call for Social Justice:** The poem promotes the value of fairness and justice, urging readers to recognize and address the inequalities faced by rural communities.

Conclusion Through his sympathetic tone and vivid imagery, Frost inspires readers to value empathy and work toward a more equitable society. The poem serves as a reminder of the importance of social justice.

3. Article-Based Question

Q. Write an article for your school magazine titled “The Forgotten Villages: Lessons from A Roadside Stand.”

Answer: Introduction *The Forgotten Villages: Lessons from A Roadside Stand* Robert Frost's poem *A Roadside Stand* sheds light on the struggles of rural communities and the indifference of urban society toward their plight.

Content

- **Rural Struggles:** The roadside stand symbolizes the desperation of rural people to earn a livelihood. They hope for customers to stop and buy their goods, but their efforts often go unnoticed.
- **Urban Exploitation:** Frost critiques the exploitation of rural areas by urban dwellers, showing how urban prosperity depends on the labor and resources of the countryside.
- **Call for Empathy:** The poem urges readers to empathize with rural communities and recognize their contributions to society.

Conclusion In conclusion, *A Roadside Stand* teaches us the importance of social justice and empathy. It reminds us that rural communities deserve recognition and support for their hard work and sacrifices.

4. Speech-Based Question

Q. Imagine you are delivering a speech at a social awareness seminar. Prepare a speech on "The Plight of Rural Communities: Insights from A Roadside Stand."

Answer: Introduction Good morning everyone, Today, I'd like to speak on "The Plight of Rural Communities: Insights from A Roadside Stand," a poem by Robert Frost that highlights the struggles of rural people and critiques urban attitudes.

Content

- **Rural Struggles:** The roadside stand in the poem symbolizes the desperation of rural people to earn a livelihood. They hope for customers to stop and buy their goods, but their efforts often go unnoticed.
- **Urban Exploitation:** Frost critiques the exploitation of rural areas by urban dwellers, showing how urban prosperity depends on the labor and resources of the countryside.
- **Call for Empathy:** The poem urges us to empathize with rural communities and recognize their contributions to society.

Conclusion In conclusion, *A Roadside Stand* teaches us the importance of social justice and empathy. Let us work together to support rural communities and address the inequalities they face.

5. Story-Based Question

Q. Narrate the story of the roadside stand in the poem as a reflection of rural struggles and urban indifference. Present it as a dramatic retelling for a school history club.

Answer: Introduction It was a small roadside stand, located at the edge of the road where traffic sped by. The rural people waited all day, hoping for customers to stop and buy their goods.

Content

- **Rural Struggles:** The stand symbolized the desperation of rural people to earn a livelihood. They hoped for the "squeal of brakes" and the sound of a stopping car, but their hopes were often in vain.

- **Urban Indifference:** Urban dwellers sped past the stand, indifferent to the struggles of the countryside. Frost critiques this attitude, showing how urban prosperity depends on rural labor and resources.
- **Emotional Despair:** The rural people's longing and sadness are vividly portrayed in the poem, reflecting their helplessness and unfulfilled hopes.

Conclusion In conclusion, the story of the roadside stand is a poignant reflection of rural struggles and urban indifference. It reminds us of the need for empathy and social justice.

6. Author's Point of View-Based Question

Q. How does Robert Frost present the story of the roadside stand in a way that blends social critique with emotional depth? Comment on the tone and style.

Answer: Introduction Robert Frost presents the story of the roadside stand with a unique blend of social critique and emotional depth, making the poem both thought-provoking and poignant.

Content

- **Social Critique:** Frost critiques the exploitation of rural areas by urban dwellers, showing how urban prosperity depends on rural labor and resources. The phrase "pathetically pled" reflects the helplessness of rural people.
- **Emotional Depth:** Frost uses vivid imagery and poignant language to portray the struggles and unfulfilled hopes of rural people. The phrase "childish longing in vain" highlights their innocence and helplessness.
- **Tone and Style:** The tone of the poem is sympathetic and critical, reflecting Frost's concern for rural communities. His style combines vivid imagery with social commentary, making the poem engaging and impactful.

Conclusion Through his unique blend of social critique and emotional depth, Frost inspires readers to empathize with rural communities and work toward social justice.

7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Q. Imagine you are one of the rural people waiting at the roadside stand. Write a diary entry expressing your thoughts, emotions, and hopes.

Answer: Introduction Diary Entry – Roadside Stand, Evening Today was another long day at the roadside stand. As I sit here, I can't help but reflect on our struggles and hopes.

Content

- **Desperation and Hope:** All day, I waited for the "squeal of brakes" and the sound of a stopping car. I hoped someone would buy our goods and help us earn a living, but few stopped.
- **Sadness and Frustration:** It's heartbreaking to see the traffic speed by, indifferent to our struggles. We work hard, yet our efforts often go unnoticed.
- **Dreams and Aspirations:** Despite the challenges, I dream of a better future where rural communities are recognized and supported for their contributions.

Conclusion As the day ends, I hold on to hope. Maybe tomorrow will bring more customers and a chance to improve our lives.